



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	10 April 2024	Time of Incident	8:00am
Directorate / Region	RMO – Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number	39559
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Catastrophic

Incident Short Description	Leaf spring dislodges from trailer and injures Member of Public.
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Executive Summary

At 6.00am, a road train driver underwent a prestart check and completing an inspection of the road train without identifying any issues. The truck was loaded with gravel and made two round trips from a pit to a compound.

At approximately 8:00am, on the second trip on their journey back to the compound, they were travelling on a highway with two Members of Public (MoP) in an LV ute followed behind the road train. Suddenly, a leaf spring approximately 60cm in length has dislodged from the underside of the rear trailer, striking the windscreen of the LV.

Although both MoP's instinctively moved their bodies and heads to the side, the leaf spring and smashed through the windscreen and struck the passengers head, resulting in a laceration.

The MoP trailed the truck for approximately 5km until they successfully drew the attention of the truck driver. Following an exchange of details between the truck driver and the MoP, the injured passenger sought medical attention at the health centre.

The incident was reported to a Superintendent who immediately suspended all truck activity until a mechanical inspection was conducted.

Incident Photos



Damage to the MoP windscreen and entry point of the leaf spring.



Leaf spring pack with two missing leaf springs and restraint bolt.

Contributing Factors

- The road train driver was not aware that a leaf spring had previously fallen from the same truck.
- Restraint bolt was missing from the leaf spring pack upon inspection post event, which allowed the second leaf spring to become loose and dislodge from its position.
- Poor conditions on highway access from the pit to various site locations.
- The risk register failed to identify hazards related to road conditions and maintenance of access roads into pits.

Corrective Actions

- All truck trailers to be inspected prior to commencement of gravel haulage to ensure no further leaf springs are found to be damaged.
- Pit haul roads to be inspected regularly and grading implemented where required to improve surface for travel.
- Include leaf spring checks as part of daily pre-starts.
- Review risk register to include risks and controls associated with road conditions.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- The incident draws attention to the impact of road conditions on the mechanical components of mobile plant and equipment.
- Poor road conditions can place additional stress on vehicle components, increasing the risk of mechanical failure. Recognising and addressing road conditions as potential hazards is crucial for preventing similar incidents.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Mobile Plant

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations